

NOTE II.

President's Instructions to Private Armed Vessels.

1. The tenor of your commission, under the act of congress, entitled, "an act concerning letters of marque, prizes and prize goods," a copy of which is hereto annexed, will be kept constantly in your view. The high seas, referred to in your commission, you will understand, generally, to refer to low-water mark; but with the exception of the space within one league, or three miles, from the shore of countries at peace both with Great Britain and the United States. You may, nevertheless, execute your commission within that distance of the shore of a nation at war with Great Britain, and even on the waters within the jurisdiction of such nation, if permitted so to do.

2. You are to pay the strictest regard to the rights of neutral powers, and the usages of civilized nations; and in all your proceedings towards neutral vessels, you are to give them as little molestation or interruption as will consist with the right of ascertaining their neutral character, and of detaining and bringing them in for regular adjudication, in the proper cases. You are particularly to avoid even the appearance of using force or seduction, with a view to deprive such vessels of their crews or of their passengers, other than persons in the military service of the enemy.

*81] 3. Towards enemy vessels and their crews, you are to proceed, in exercising the rights of war, with all the justice and humanity which characterize the nation of which you are members.

4. The master, and one or more of the principal persons belonging to the captured vessels, are to be sent, as soon after the capture as may be, to the judge or judges of the proper court in the United States, to be examined upon oath, touching the interest or property of the captured vessel and her lading; and at the same time, are to be delivered to the judge or judges, all passes, charter-parties, bills of lading, invoices, letters and other documents, and writings found on board; the said papers to be proved by the affidavit of the commander of the capturing vessel, or some other person present at the capture, to be produced, as they were received, without fraud, addition, subduction or embezzlement.

By the command of the President of the United States.

JAMES MONROE, Secretary of State.

NOTE III.

The Standing Interrogatories.

1st Interrogate.—What is your name, where were you born, and where have you lived for the last seven years? Where do you now live, and how long have you lived in that place? To what prince or state, or to whom are you, or have you ever been, a subject? Are you a married man, and if married, where do your wife and family reside?

2d Interrogate.—Were you present at the time of taking and seizing the ship, or her lading, or any of the goods or merchandises concerning which you are now examined? Had the ship concerning which you are now examined any commission; what, and from whom?

*82] 3d Interrogate.—In what place, latitude or port, and when, was the *said ship and goods concerning which you are now examined, taken and seized? Upon what pretence, and for what reasons were they seized? Into what port were

Standing Interrogatories.

they carried, and under what colors did the said ship sail? What other colors had you on board, and for what reason had you such other colors? Was any resistance made, at the time when the said ship was taken? and if yea, how many guns were fired? and by whom? and by what ship or ships were you taken? Was the ship or vessel by which you were captured, a ship of war, or a vessel acting without any commission, as you believe? Were any other and what ships in sight, at the time of the capture?

4th Interrogate.—What is the name of the master or commander of the ship or vessel taken? How long have you known the said master, and who appointed him to the command of said vessel? Where did said commander take possession of her, at what time, and what was the name of the person who delivered the possession to the said master? Where doth he live? Where is the said master's fixed place of abode, and where doth he generally reside? How long has he lived there, where was he born, and of whom is he now a subject? Is he married? If yea, where does his wife and family reside?

5th Interrogate.—Of what burden is the vessel which has been taken? What was the number of her mariners, and of what country were the said seamen and mariners? Did they all come on board at the same port, or at different ports, and who shipped or hired them, and when and where?

6th Interrogate.—Had you, or any of the officers or mariners belonging to the ship or vessel, concerning which you are now examined, any, and what, part, share or interest in the said vessel or her lading? If yea, set forth who and what goods or interest you or they have? Did you belong to the said vessel, at the time she was seized and taken? In what capacity did you belong to her? How long have you known her? When and where did you first see her, and where was she built?

7th Interrogate.—What is the name of the vessel? How long has she been so called? Do you know of any other name or names, and what are they, by which she has heretofore been called? Had she any passport or sea-chart on board, and from whom? To what ports and places did she sail, during her said voyage, before she was taken? Where did her last voyage begin, and where was the said voyage to have ended? From what port, and at what time, particularly from the last clearing port, did the said ship sail, previously to the capture? Set forth all the ports to which she has sailed, and at which she has touched and traded, during her whole voyage, out and home.

*8th Interrogate.—What lading did the said vessel carry, at the time of her first setting sail on her last voyage, and what sort of lading and goods had she [*83 on board, at the time she was taken? When was the same put on board? Set forth the different species of lading, and the quantity of each sort. Has any part of the cargo of said vessel been unladen, since the commencement of her original voyage? If so, at what ports or places was it unladen? State the articles which were unladen.

9th Interrogate.—Who were the owners of the vessel, at the time when she was seized? How do you know that they were owners at that time? Of what nation or country are such owners by birth? Where do they reside, and where do their wives and families reside? How long have they resided there? Where did they reside before, to the best of your knowledge? To whom are they subject? How long have the present owners been in possession? and of whom did they purchase?

10th Interrogate.—Was any bill of sale made, and by whom, to the aforesaid owners of said vessel? and if any such were made, in what month and year, and where, and in the presence of what witnesses? Was any, and what, engagement entered into concerning the purchase, further than appears on the bill of sale? If yea, was it verbal or in writing? Where did you last see it, and what has become of it?

11th Interrogate.—Was the said lading put on board in one port and at one time, or at several ports and at several times, and at what ports, by name? Set forth what quantities of each sort of goods were shipped at each port.

12th Interrogate.—What are the names of the respective laders or owners, or con-

Standing Interrogatories.

signees of said goods? What countrymen are they? Where do they now live and carry on their business? How long have they resided there? Where did they reside before, to the best of your knowledge? And where were the said goods to be delivered, and for whose real account, risk or benefit? Have any one of the said consignees or shippers, any and what interest in the said goods? If yea, whereon do you found your belief, that they have such interest? Do you verily believe, that at the time of the lading the cargo, and at the present time, and also if said goods shall be restored and unladen at the destined port, the goods did, do, and will belong to the same persons, and to none others?

13th Interrogate.—How many bills of lading were signed for the goods seized on board the said ship? Were any of those bills of lading false or colorable, or were any
 *84] bills of lading signed, which were *different in any respect from those which were on board the ship, at the time she was taken? What were the contents of such other bills of lading, and what became of them?

14th Interrogate.—Are there in the United States of America any bills of lading, invoices, letters or instruments relative to the ship and goods, concerning which you are now examined? If yea, set forth where they are, and in whose possession, and what is the purport thereof, and when they were brought or sent to the United States.

15th Interrogate.—Was there any charter-party signed for the voyage, in which the ship, concerning which you are now examined, was seized and taken? What became thereof? When, where, and between whom, was such charter-party made? What were the contents of it?

16th Interrogate.—What papers, bills of lading, letters or other writings, were on board the ship, at the time she took her departure from the last clearing port, before her being taken as prize? Were any of them burnt, torn, thrown overboard, destroyed or cancelled, or attempted to be concealed, and when, and by whom, and who was then present?

17th Interrogate.—Has the ship, concerning which you are now examined, been, at any time, and when, seized as prize, and condemned as such? If yea, set forth into what port she was carried, and by whom, and by what authority, or on what account she was condemned?

18th Interrogate.—Have you sustained any loss by the seizing and taking the ship, concerning which you are now examined? If yea, in what manner do you compute such your loss? Have you already received any indemnity, satisfaction or promise of satisfaction, for any part of the damage which you have sustained, or may sustain, by this capture and detention, and when, and from whom?

19th Interrogate.—Is the said ship, or goods, or any, and what part, insured? If yea, for what voyage is such insurance made, and at what premium, and when and by what persons, and in what country was such insurance made?

20th Interrogate.—In case you had arrived at your destined port, would your cargo, or any part thereof, on being unladen, have immediately become the property of the consignees, or any other person, and whom? Or was the lader to take the chance of the market for the sale of his goods?

21st Interrogate.—Let each witness be interrogated of the growth, produce, and manufacture of what country and place was the lading of the ship or vessel, concerning which you are now examined, or any part thereof?

*85] *22d Interrogate.—Whether all the said cargo, or any, and what part thereof, was taken from the shore or quay, or removed or transhipped from one boat, barque, vessel or ship, to another? From what, and to what shore, quay, boat, barque, vessel or ship, and when and where, was the same so done.

23d Interrogate.—Are there, in any other country, and where, or on board any and what ship or ships, vessel or vessels, other than the ship and vessel concerning which you are now examined, any bills of lading, invoices, letters, instruments, papers or documents, relative to the said ship, or vessel and cargo, and of what nature are such bills of lading, invoices, letters, instruments, papers or documents, and what are the